

5.b) Contribution of Stephen Tyler to school of Cognitive Anthropology

Stephen Tyler belongs to the Cognitive Anthropology school. He is also called the "father of Cognitive Anthropology".

Major contributions to cognitive anthropology

→ He said cognitive anthropology is study of how different people organize and classify the outer world.

→ Humans have tendency of classification
↳ It is through it that we bring the infinite world into manipulable size.

→ Unfortunately, the classification methods are arbitrary and no universal methods.

→ He said to study domains of

Language to understand how different
cultures are different.

[Eg] In his work "Koyas: An Outline
Grammar" he compared them with
Americans ⇒

• Americans have multiple words
for precipitation like snow, hail, rain
(domain) etc.

But Koyas only have Manchu (word)

↳ But Koyas have 7 words for
Bamboo and Americans one.

⇒ He said no integrative pattern to
study different domains.

Criticism

① Keising → Only trivial domains studied.
& not complex culture practice.

② Abstract and hard to reciprocate.

③ Language shaping world view ⇒ How then
people with multiple language perceive.

Tyler enriched the future works
through his works of new ethnography